



Follow Up & Next Steps

Everything you need to keep your momentum going after today's class

1 THANK YOU FOR ATTENDING

Congratulations on taking this important step toward homeownership! You've invested your time in learning how to use one of the greatest benefits earned through your service — the VA Home Loan. This document is your personal roadmap to turn what you learned today into action.

REMEMBER THIS

You don't have to figure this out alone. Carmen and Sydney are here to walk alongside you at every step of your home buying journey — from your first questions to the day you get your keys.

2 KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM TODAY'S CLASS

- **Your VA benefit is powerful** — no down payment, no PMI, and competitive rates make it one of the best loan products available.
- **Eligibility is the first step** — obtain your Certificate of Eligibility (COE) early; your lender can often pull it directly.
- **Credit matters, but it doesn't have to be perfect** — most VA-approved lenders accept scores of 580+; there are steps you can take now to improve yours.
- **Pre-approval is your power move** — sellers take pre-approved buyers more seriously, giving you a competitive edge in any market.
- **Closing costs are manageable** — you can negotiate seller concessions up to 4% to cover them, and the VA funding fee can be rolled into the loan.
- **The VA appraisal protects you** — minimum property requirements ensure the home is safe, sound, and a fair value.
- **Working with the right team matters** — choose a lender and real estate agent experienced in VA transactions.

3 YOUR PERSONALIZED ACTION PLAN

Work through this list at your own pace. Check off each item as you complete it.

- ☐ **Obtain your Certificate of Eligibility (COE)** DO FIRST
Visit va.gov/housing-assistance/home-loans or ask your lender to pull it for you.
- ☐ **Pull your credit reports from all 3 bureaus** DO FIRST
Visit AnnualCreditReport.com — free, official, and no credit score impact.
- ☐ **Dispute any errors on your credit report** DO FIRST
Even small errors can drag your score down. Dispute them directly with each bureau.
- ☐ **Calculate your debt-to-income ratio (DTI)** THIS WEEK
Total monthly debt ÷ gross monthly income. Aim for 41% or lower.
- ☐ **Gather your financial documents** THIS WEEK
Last 2 years of tax returns, W-2s, 2 months of pay stubs, 2 months of bank statements.
- ☐ **Book your free 1-on-1 consultation with Carmen & Sydney** DO FIRST
Get a personalized plan tailored to your exact situation and timeline.
- ☐ **Get pre-approved by a VA-approved lender** THIS MONTH
Shop at least 2–3 lenders to compare rates and terms. Your COE will be needed.
- ☐ **Research neighborhoods in your target area** ONGOING
Consider commute time, schools, amenities, and future resale value.
- ☐ **Connect with a VA-experienced real estate agent** THIS MONTH
Ask specifically about their experience with VA loans and MPR requirements.
- ☐ **Set up home listing alerts on Zillow, Realtor.com, or MLS** ONGOING
Know what's available in your price range before you're actively shopping.

4 SUGGESTED HOME BUYING TIMELINE

WEEK 1–2 · START NOW

Get Organized

Pull credit reports, gather documents, obtain COE, book your consultation with W+AHT.

WEEK 3–4 · BUILD YOUR TEAM

Get Pre-Approved

Shop VA-approved lenders, compare offers, get your pre-approval letter in hand.

MONTH 2–3 · START SHOPPING

Find Your Home

Work with your agent to view homes, understand VA MPRs, and identify your target property.

MONTH 3–4 · MAKE IT OFFICIAL

Make an Offer & Go Under Contract

Negotiate seller concessions, order VA appraisal, complete inspections.

MONTH 4–5 · THE FINISH LINE

Close & Get Your Keys

Final underwriting, clear to close, sign documents, and celebrate your new home!

5 HELPFUL RESOURCES



U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs

Official VA home loan information, COE application, and lender search.

va.gov/housing-assistance/home-loans



Free Credit Reports

Get your free annual credit reports from all three bureaus — no strings attached.

annualcreditreport.com



Consumer Financial Protection Bureau

Free tools, guides, and calculators for first-time homebuyers.

consumerfinance.gov/owning-a-home



VA Loan Calculator

Estimate your monthly payment, funding fee, and total cost with a VA loan.

va.gov/housing-assistance/home-loans/loan-limits

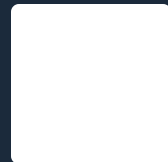
6 YOUR NEXT STEP — BOOK YOUR FREE CONSULTATION

Ready to Map Out Your Personal Path to Homeownership?

Book a FREE 30-minute 1-on-1 consultation with Carmen or Sydney. We'll review your specific situation, answer all your questions, and create a clear plan just for you.



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7 MY PERSONAL COMMITMENT

Write down your goal and sign it — studies show that writing your commitment increases follow-through.

I commit to taking the following action within the next 7 days:

MY NAME

TODAY'S DATE

MY TARGET MOVE-IN DATE

SIGNATURE

Thank you for your service. It is an honor to help you achieve the dream of homeownership.
— Carmen & Sydney, W+AHT

W+AHT